# Start here

**Physics PhD Atlas 2027 · version 1.1 · data checked October 22, 2026**

Thank you for buying the Atlas. Your kit contains:

| File | What it's for |
|---|---|
| **Atlas.html** | Offline program explorer. Open it in any browser, filter, star programs, export your shortlist. Tap any value to see the exact official sentence and its link. |
| **Atlas.xlsx** | Planner workbook: Programs, Shortlist (auto-fills deadlines, fees, rules), Budget, Recommenders, Supervisor outreach, Sources. Works in Excel, Google Sheets (File → Import) and LibreOffice. |
| **Atlas.csv** | The same program data for any other tool. |
| **Playbook.pdf** | Step-by-step guidance: timeline, English tests, GRE, Canadian supervisors, how Europe differs, SOP, letters, fee waivers, checklist. |
| **LICENSE.txt** | What you may and may not do with the files. |

## Your first 15 minutes

1. Open **Atlas.html** and tap the **Quick picks** that match you, e.g. *Physics GRE not needed*, *English-test waiver possible*, *Bachelor's OK* or *Funded*. On a phone, tap **Filters** for the full set.
2. Star 8-15 programs and click **Export shortlist (CSV)**, or pick them in the **Shortlist** tab of Atlas.xlsx.
3. Read Playbook Sections 2-9, which cover the decisions with deadlines this month: the UK, the rest of Europe, Australia and Canada each work differently.
4. Before paying any fee, click the value and open the official page. Rules change mid-cycle.

## What the labels mean

- **Not stated**: the official pages we checked did not say. This is *not* a "no", so ask the program.
- **Year inferred**: the page gave a day and month only; we assumed the 2027-entry cycle.
- **Per position / Rolling**: no central deadline. You apply to a professor or an advertised position (common in Europe).
- **Sources conflict**: two official pages disagree. We show both and use the safer number.
- **≈ ₹ amounts**: application fees converted to rupees at the Bank of Canada rate on the date shown at the bottom of Atlas.html. They're approximate, and your bank adds a margin.
- **Licence**: a *Personal* licence is for you. A *Batch* licence lets you share the files with up to 30 people in one batch, society or mentoring group.

## Updates and corrections

You get every update for the Fall 2027 cycle free. Gumroad emails you when a new version is uploaded. If you spot a changed or wrong value, reply to your purchase receipt with the program name and the page link.

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